

Also known as the entrepreneurial visa.

Portugal's oldest visa: what is the D2?

It is Portugal's longest-standing residency route, open for more than twenty years and one of the most used ways into the country. What it asks is simple: run a real business in Portugal, backed by a plan that holds up to review, and show that you can support both yourself and the business until you reach permanent residency.

No fixed min.

INVESTMENT THRESHOLD

2 + 3 yrs

PERMIT, THEN RENEWAL

5 years

TO PERMANENT
RESIDENCY

Family

SPOUSE, CHILDREN,
PARENTS

There is no legal minimum investment. What is assessed is your business plan and your means.

How does the D2 work, stage by stage?

Because there is no fixed amount to invest, the business plan is the application. It has to describe a real activity, with revenue that is credible, and show that you can fund both the company and yourself while it gets established.

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- 01 Advice and business plan**
We look at your profile, then build a workable plan around a real activity in Portugal — one that will hold up when it is reviewed.

 - 02 Company set-up**
We oversee the incorporation with specialist local lawyers and put together your proof of sufficient funds.

 - 03 Visa application**
Your D2 application is submitted at the Portuguese consulate in the country where you live.

 - 04 Arrival and residence permit**
When you arrive, the visa becomes a two-year residence permit. You then register your address and your tax number.

 - 05 Renewal and permanent residency**
The permit is renewed for a further three years. After five years of legal residence you can apply for permanent residency.
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TIMING

How long does it take?

Most complete applications receive the visa within a few months. It becomes a two-year residence permit when you arrive, renewable for a further three years. Permanent residency is available after five years of legal residence, and citizenship follows separately under the nationality law in force.

A few months

TYPICAL VISA ISSUE, COMPLETE FILE

2 years

FIRST RESIDENCE PERMIT

+ 3 years

RENEWAL TO THE FIVE-YEAR MARK



What is the simplest D2 business to run?

A property business. You buy a property in the company’s name and let it out, long or short term, and the rent is the company’s revenue. Next to that monthly income the company holds an asset that grows in value, so the plan has both a trading income and a growth asset behind it. In a market like Lisbon, that is a sound business in its own right, not only a route to residency.

The simplest way to run it is to let us run it. We manage the whole process and let the property through our own management operation, so the business works without you having to work it.

AN ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

€280,000

QUALIFYING PROPERTY INVESTMENT

7%

TARGET NET RENTAL YIELD

Scoped

PROCESS COSTS, PER BUSINESS

Illustrative only: a €280,000 property bought in the company’s name, with a 7% target net rental yield based on current letting evidence. Process costs change with the business and are listed item by item once we have scoped your plan.

What the company does	Buys and lets residential property, earning rent and holding the asset.
Where the revenue comes from	A long-term tenancy, or licensed short-stay letting, depending on the property and the district.
What we run	Sourcing, checks, incorporation, letting, maintenance and quarterly reporting to the company.
What you keep	Ownership of the company and of the asset, and a plan that keeps working even if you never move in.

Yield figures are targets based on current letting evidence, not guarantees; returns depend on the property, occupancy and costs. Short-stay letting is subject to local licensing. Figures current as of July 2026.

What makes a D2 application succeed?

A business that is real. We build plans around activities that genuinely operate, and then we operate them. That is the difference between a file that is approved and renewed, and one that is approved and then quietly fails at the three-year mark.

Profile and eligibility	An honest view on whether the D2 is the right route for you, before any money is spent.
The business plan	Built around a real activity, with revenue assumptions we can evidence rather than simply claim.
Incorporation and funds	Company set-up with specialist local lawyers, and your proof of sufficient means put together correctly.
The property, if that is the plan	Sourced, checked and bought in the company's name, with the letting economics confirmed first.
Operating and renewing	Management, accounts and reporting run on the company's behalf, so every renewal is straightforward.

ABOUT SMITH & ADAMS

Who are we, and how can we help?

The Smith & Adams Group is a Lisbon-based real estate group operating as an owner-operator with an integrated advisory practice, covering the full asset lifecycle from acquisition and renovation to letting, operation, and disposal. With over 10 years in the Portuguese market, 500+ units delivered, and €30M+ in advised investments, it serves international private investors seeking stable euro returns and access to Portugal through pathways like the Golden Visa and D2 Visa. Guided by values of independence, performance discipline, and transparency, the group operates across five practices under one institutional standard, including property management, letting, investment advisory, and the endorsed Hygge House brand.

TALK TO AN ADVISOR

One conversation, no obligation, and an honest answer on whether this route fits you.

[Book a call →](#)

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